PASCAL MUROMBA

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Research Interests

Development Studies, Agrarian Studies, Gender and Agricultural Development

Education

University of Ottawa (Canada) 2026–Present
Doctoral Program in International Development

Tohoku University (Japan) 2024–2026
Master's Program in Agricultural Science (Agricultural Economics)
Thesis – Gender and Mobile Agricultural Technology Adoption among Fast Track Land Reform Programme Beneficiaries

Ritsumeikan Asia Pacific University (Japan) 2019–2023
BBA in Innovation and Economics

Research and Professional Experience

Field Work Coordinator, International Development Lab, Tohoku University 2025
Project: Post-COVID-19 Child Labor in Zimbabwe's Fast Track Land Reform Settlements

Led primary data collection across 300 households in Zimbabwe's Fast Track Land Reform settlements, coordinating field logistics and quality assurance.
Trained and supervised 10 enumerators in survey administration protocols and ethical research practices.
Executed data cleaning and validation using R, producing a publication-ready dataset.

Research Assistant, International Development Lab, Tohoku University 2025
Project: Education Lost, Labor Gained: A Systematic Review of COVID-19's Impact on Children in South Asia

Conducted a scoping review that screened 200 papers and synthesized 36 final studies on socio-behavioral determinants of agricultural child labor in rural Southeast Asia in the post-COVID-19 context.
Developed PRISMA-based methodology with standardized protocols and conducted qualitative analysis of 36 primary sources using NVivo.
Contributed to manuscript development by co-authoring the literature review and drafting analytical memos for the findings section.

Lead Reservation Associate, Ritz Carlton Reserve, Japan 2023–2024

Spearheaded client relationship management for 1,000+ travel agents, improving annual booking retention rates by 73% through strategic communication and tailored solutions.
Analyzed financial data to optimize revenue and identify discrepancies, contributing to a 34% increase in net profit during peak season.
Collaborated with Sales and Finance departments to design promotional stay packages, increasing off-season revenue by 25%.

Graduate and Alumni Team (GAT) Intern, Ashinaga Foundation (NGO) 2022–2023

Analyzed survey data from 450+ scholarship recipients using R, generating strategic recommendations that led to the launch of an entrepreneurship incubator program.
Strengthened Ashinaga's global community engagement by authoring 8 alumni feature articles for a newsletter reaching 5,000+ subscribers.

Teaching Assistant, University of Ottawa 2026
Canada and the Challenges of International Development and Globalization (Undergraduate Credit Course).

Teaching Assistant, Tohoku University 2025
Scientific English (Undergraduate Credit Course, taught by Professor Minakshi Keeni).

Teaching Assistant, Ritsumeikan Asia Pacific University 2021–2022
Study Skills and Academic Writing (Undergraduate Credit Course, taught by Professor Yoo Bosul).
Global Enhancement Program (GCEP) (Professional Development Course, taught by Professor Hirai Tatsuya).

Publications

Muromba, P., Keeni, M., & Fuyuki, K. (2025). A systematic review of mobile agricultural service applications for smallholder farmers: Perspectives from the technology acceptance model. *Agriculture & Food Security*. https://doi.org/10.1186/s40066-025-00563-y

Muromba, P., & Keeni, M. (2026). Education lost, labor gained: A systematic review of COVID-19's impact on children in South Asia. *Social Sciences & Humanities Open*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ssaho.2026.102949

Muromba, P., Keeni, M., & Fuyuki, K. (Accepted with minor revisions). *Rice supply shocks and university student consumption patterns in Japan.*

Muromba, P., Wei, J., Magezi, E. F., & Fuyuki, K. (Working paper). *Women's household decision-making and children's educational progression: Evidence from rural Zimbabwe.*

Conference Presentations

Understanding Adoption Dynamics: Mobile Applications and Women Smallholder Farmers
10th Atlanta Conference on Science and Innovation Policy, USA — May 2025

Rice Supply Shocks and University Student Consumption Patterns in Japan
16th Int. Conf. on Environmental and Rural Development, Japan — March 2025

Systematic Review of Mobile Agricultural Service Applications for Smallholder Farmers: Perspectives from the Technology Acceptance Model
SPRINGER Nature and The University of Tokyo, SDGs Symposium 2025, Japan — February 2025

Unlocking Potential: Digital Technology and Women's Participation in Smallholder Farming
Ritsumeikan, Center for Inclusive Leadership, Inclusion and Sustainability Conference, Japan — June 2024

Food Security: To what extent does education influence farm input usage decisions? A case study of smallholder farmers in Zimbabwe.
Ritsumeikan Asia Pacific University, 20th Asia Pacific Conference, Japan — December 2022

Awards, Honors, and Grants

International Doctoral Scholarship, University of Ottawa	2026
Doctoral Admission Scholarship, University of Ottawa	2026
School of International Development and Global Studies Scholarship, University of Ottawa	2026
24th IMF Asia-Pacific Regional Office Macroeconomist Training Program—Selectee (1 of 20)	2025
Suisei Agricultural Science Promotion Association Research Travel Grant Award	2025
Oita Prefectural Government of Japan Academic Excellence Scholarship Award	2023
Foundation for the Advancement of Life and Insurance Research Competition, 2nd Runner Up	2022
Monbukagakusho Honors Scholarship for Privately Financed International Students	2020

Technical Skills

R, STATA, SPSS, NVivo, LaTeX, KoBoToolBox, Mendeley, QGIS, Advanced Excel.

Languages

English (native level), Shona (native level), Japanese (business level)